

When Rhea became pregnant with her sixth child, she decided to try to protect her baby from Cronos. She traveled to Crete to give birth far away from her husband and asked her mother, Gaia, for help. Gaia assisted Rhea in delivering the boy and then hid him in a cave. When Cronos learned that Rhea had brought a son into the world, he went to find her and demanded: "Give me the boy!"

"Here you are," said Rhea. However, instead of giving Cronos his son to swallow, Rhea handed him a rock wrapped in a blanket. It did not even occur to Cronos to check what was inside.

*Cronos swallowed the thickly swaddled rock without a second thought.*

Rhea's youngest son was safe, and she named him Zeus. Since Cronos believed he had swallowed all six of his children, Zeus was able to grow up in peace.

